

SPEAKER KIT · 2026

Sahara Al-Madi

Computational linguist · AI security and governance · Founder,
Linguistic Security Institute

*What do AI systems owe the communities
whose languages they process?*





ABOUT

A linguist building systems that are secure, accountable, and educational for the communities they serve.

Sahara founded the Linguistic Security Institute, an open-source research initiative built on one principle: AI systems must be accountable to the communities whose languages they process.

ACL 2026 published

7 engagements in 2026

English · Spanish · Italian · Arabic · Low resource language research



LINGUISTIC SECURITY

The principle that AI systems must be accountable to the communities whose languages they process.

It asks not only whether a system works, but for whom it works, whom it fails, and who gets to decide.



THREE PILLARS

What we hold AI systems to

01

Data sovereignty

Who controls the language data, and who benefits?

Communities consent to how their languages are represented and share in the value they create.

02

Transparency

Which languages are included, which are missing, and how does each fare?

Per-language reporting is required, as each language presents distinct needs & outcomes.

03

Social value

Does the system serve the community, or extract from it?

Accuracy alone is not enough if outputs cause harm.

Language is both a community's inheritance and a system's attack surface.



SIGNATURE TALKS

Four talks, tailored to each audience

SECURITY · RED TEAMS

Polyglot Poisoning: Hunting Linguistic Attacks in AI

Testing AI guardrails across dialects, writing systems, and code-switching, with a live red-team demonstration.

POLICY · GEOSCIENCE

Who Speaks for the Data?

Exploring parallels between language, AI ethics and the governance of non-human data across space and conservation contexts.

EDUCATORS · LANGUAGE PROGRAMS

To Listen is to Inherit

How human traditions of listening and carrying memory shape our expectations of what language systems should remember, retain, and carry forward.

SPACE POLICY · ETHICS

Seven Generations in Orbit

Space debris and orbital decisions are treated as relational matters, shaped through deliberation.

Delivered in English or Spanish · virtual, in person or hybrid · custom topics welcome



FORMATS

From a keynote to a hands-on lab

Every session ends with something the audience can use: a framework to apply, a tool to run, or a question to take back to their own systems.

Keynote	30–60 min
Conference talk or panel	20–45 min
Hands-on workshop	2–4 hours
Guest lecture or seminar	50–90 min
Assessment and advisory	Scoped



LIVE DEMOS

Talks come with working tools

AI SECURITY · BSIDES SAN DIEGO 2026

Linguistic Firewall: Polyglot Poisoning

Probes LLM guardrails with dialects, scripts and code-switching. Basis for the DEATHCon 2026 workshop.

github.com/LinguisticSecurityInstitute/linguistic-firewall

YOHAKU HACKATHON · CHALLENGE 2

Seven Generations in Orbit

A decision tool for space-debris responsibility, built on seven questions grounded in Lakota principles.

almadilsitask2yohaku.kimi.page

<https://github.com/LinguisticSecurityInstitute/YOHAKU2026>



2026 ENGAGEMENTS

Seven stages across five fields

DATE	EVENT	AUDIENCE	FORMAT
Jan 24	Tech Intersections, Northeastern	Equity in cybersecurity	In person
Mar 16	GEO Indigenous Summit	Earth observationPolicy	Virtual
Apr 4	BSides San Diego	Cybersecurity	In person
Oct 9	YOHAKU Space Global Showcase	Earth observationSpace DebrisPolicy	Virtual
Oct 11	GSA Connects 2026, Denver	GeosciencePolicy	In person
Oct 16	Technology for Second Language Learning	Language education	Virtual
Nov 14	DEATHCon / BSides San Diego	Cybersecurity	Hybrid



RESEARCH

Peer-reviewed work behind the talks

ACL 2026 · SEMEVAL TASK 9 · PUBLISHED JULY 3, 2026

NAMAA at SemEval-2026 Task 9: Comparing Generative, Retrieval-Augmented, and Discriminative Methods for Arabic Online Polarization Detection

Error analysis lead across 10+ LLMs: dialectal bias, hallucinations and gold-label inconsistencies.

ARABIC NLP @ EMNLP 2026 · BAREC · PUBLISHED OCTOBER 28, 2026

LSI at BAREC Shared Task 2026: Training Convergence, Heuristics, and Ensembles for Arabic Sentence-Level Readability

Solo author. Ranked 1st in the Constrained Track, 3rd in Open Track



WORKING TOGETHER

Open by default, sustainable by design

Open Source

Free

Community, Indigenous and language organizations, student groups, open-source projects.

Open tools and materials, recorded talks, virtual community sessions as availability allows.

Professional

Fee on request

Conferences, universities, companies, professional associations.

Tailored keynotes and talks, hands-on workshops with lab materials, planning call and attendee resources.

Partner

Custom scope

Teams deploying multilingual AI, public sector, foundations.

Linguistic security assessments, training series, governance advisory, research collaboration.

Paid engagements help sustain LSI's open-source work and keep the community tier available.





Bring linguistic security to your stage

Share your audience, dates and goals through the inquiry form. For in-person events, 6–8 weeks' notice is ideal.

almadisahara.com/speaking

linguisticsecurityinstitute@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/madisahara